The Mountainside

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CMA Members Offer Financial Assistance in Large Numbers

Finance Chair Says Bank Loan Might Be Avoided

CMA Members have responded with enthusiasm to the call for pledges to loan the association funds for the infrastructure upgrade. Finance Chair Bob Dowling said that as of the July board meeting, more than $85,000 in pledges have been received. CMA members were solicited to make $5,000 or $10,000 pledges in a special mailing in May.

Dowling said that because of the response, he asked that the deadline for making pledges be extended to July 15. Note: Please send your response to the call for pledges to:

Bob Dowling
15428 Quail Run Drive
Gaithersburg, MD 20878

Dowling said, "if a few more CMA members make pledges, we will all win. Members win by getting a very competitive return on their investment, and CMA wins because with enough pledges, we might be able to finance our part of the upgrade work without borrowing money from a bank. That saves CMA money because the interest the bank would charge an organization like ours is high."

CMA will pay 8% interest on the loans used, with repayment of principle and interest in eight installments over four years. A minimum of $5,000 is requested. Members who pledge funds will have between August and November to send their checks. Thirty days notice will be given before checks need to be mailed.

Annual Assessment Notices Coming

Assessment invoices will be sent to all CMA members by July 15. Members have thirty days to send their payment, with penalties beginning after 30 days. If you plan to travel during that period, please send your check in advance to avoid a late penalty.

Payments ($750 for a lot with a house, $420 per lot without a house) should be made to CMA, c/o Anne Marie Doppman, Treasurer 8513 Scarboro Court, Potomac, MD 20854.

And one more money item:

WATER PAYMENTS DUE

Have you sent your water bill payment yet? You should have received your water bill in late May. If you have not received a water bill, please call Jim Bradfield at (301) 984-9657.

Recreation Facilities Looking Good!

In the next couple of weeks, take a look at the tennis courts! The CMA board approved a complete resurfacing of the courts, which should be completed (weather permitting) very soon. Also, we are installing a wonderful fiberglass backboard for those tennis players who can't find a partner, or need to practice. *(Why DID Marvin Steinberg want a backboard so much? Hmmm.)*

For you basketball enthusiasts *(hoop dreams, indeed!)* there is a new backboard and net for some pick-up roundball! One-on-one, anyone?

The pool is, of course, up and running with expectations for a hot and busy season. Please make sure your family and guests have their appropriate badges with them and know the following:

POOL Hours:
(Lifeguard on duty)
Monday through Thursday:
1 - 5 p.m.
Friday/Saturday: 11 a.m. - 7 p.m.
Sunday: 11 a.m. - 4 p.m.
Hot Tub Hours:
Friday: 4 - 7 p.m.
Saturday 5 - 7 p.m.

To make special arrangements for use of the pool and/or hot tub at other times, or for additional information, contact Henry Lynn at (304) 258-5003. There is a charge for additional lifeguard hours beyond those listed above.

DACC Guidelines Revised and Approved

The CMA Board unanimously approved the revisions to the CMA "Guidelines for Building at Coolfont" document. A copy of the revised document will be sent to all members shortly. The new guidelines are far more user-friendly, with clearer, more precise inclusions concerning building standards, while also strengthening some regulations.

Many of the changes are the direct result of survey work of CMA members conducted by DACC Chair Linda Clark, with help from Pat Schenk.

That survey showed where members wanted the regs tightened, and where some were felt to be too restrictive.

Of special interest to those planning new construction at Coolfont is the availability of a new computerized topographic survey of our entire mountainside and each lot, to allow you to submit precise plans to DACC for new construction location and review your lot for locations of utilities and other easements.

As Linda put it, "the beauty of the natural environment is a major reason that we purchased property at Coolfont. Most of us would like it to stay naturally beautiful, but hard work is required to maintain it."

She also asks that owners take a look around their property (and common land) and clean up any trash that may have accumulated. Look for those old pink or orange survey flags that may have been tied to trees and branches, and remove them if they are no longer being used.

Special thanks should be given to Linda and Pat for their work. We'll all benefit from it.

President's Column

Another Great Day at CMA

The June Board meeting was a milestone. Your finance chair, Bob Dowling, announced that, at that time, seventy-five thousand dollars had been pledged by members as loans to assist the association with the upcoming infrastructure upgrade! From a number of vantage points, the news was heartening. Nearly an entire community has involved itself in the betterment of our mountainside. From volunteer leaders, to vote-casting home and lot owners, to generous members, the ride toward progress has taken us from one success story to another. The Board has now extended the opportunity for members to pledge loan funds with the hope that CMA may never have to pay interest to a bank! And that's not all!

A report by our engineer, John Lewis detailing features of the upgrade has been completed. Plans were discussed at the May Board meeting at Coolfont. By September, the upgrade work could begin. The Public Services Commission has preliminarily upheld the water rate we CMA voted to approve. CMA filed materials with the Administrative Law Judge. The rate will undergo review a year from now.

DACC Chair Linda Clark submitted an improved set of guidelines and regulations for building homes and improving property. The recommendations were approved by the Board. The document now contains appeal and waiver provisions for members experiencing extraordinary circumstances with their projects. The regulations have been improved with regard to construction standards. Rules have been added to further protect the appearance and safety of the community as well as to protect the infrastructure. A new five bedroom maximum for new homes was agreed upon. The Board has also requested the strengthening of covenant restrictions to support the regulations and remedy other governance problems.

Tennis court renovations have been ordered. By mid-July, all four courts will be completed. A fund has been set up to bring about substantial swimming pool improvements. Once the water-sewer upgrade is completed, a road improvement project will begin. A security patrol arrangement has been completed and goes into effect soon. The Board has also approved a set of bylaw changes for submission to the membership.

Fact finding and planning on all these projects has had total leader involvement. Yes, we've had a great day, and a great year.

Arleigh

RUN FOR IT!

CMA is a volunteer organization, and the future of our community depends on the goodwill and effort of all of us. In that spirit, please take a moment to consider running for office. Three board seats will be filled.

Now is a great time to do so. Some of the biggest policy problems have been solved, and the future of the organization is focused on improving what we already have.

We are setting up an organization that is far easier to manage, and organizational systems that allow the new board members to hit the ground running!

We even have some very nice people to work with.

Your few hours per week could make a big contribution to life on our mountainside.

If you're interested, please call the Chair of the nominating committee, Don Fox, or any Board member or a nominating committee member.

NEW FIRE RULES ON THE MOUNTAINSIDE

The new DACC rules contain specific language regarding open fires or log burning.

In short: the community doesn't want open fires.

This year, Virginia and West Virginia are often in high fire hazard status, and our investments on the mountain are too valuable to allow man-made fire danger to exist. The new rules state that the only fires allowed must be in above-ground, metal barbecue receptacles or DACC-approved above-ground stone or brick barbecues with chimneys and spark arrestors, with no burning on or in the ground or in fire pits.

The new rules are in effect now. Please abide by them; one forest fire from one spark from one open burn can destroy all we love here.

Mountainside Secrets

Each newsletter has carried an article with tips from our members about special joys surrounding Coolfont. Please send some of your own secrets to Jackson Bain - 609 Oakley Place, Alexandria, VA 22302. This month, a sampler by Kitty Connor of the wonderful antique finds to be found in the town of Bath.

Antiques & Collectibles

by Kitty Connor

The Antiques and Collectibles business is flourishing in Berkeley Springs. Most shops are open everyday but Wednesday. An ideal day can be spent exploring and discovering wonderful treasures, while meeting friendly, interesting people. Start early and stop at yard sales (check the Morgan Messenger newspaper for details).

The Bath Street Market, now in its second year, opens at 9 a.m. every Saturday morning. The fruits and vegetables are wonderful, and of special interest are the fresh cut flowers (and the low prices). Usually, there are also several dealers who have tables with Collectibles and few Antiques, along with vendors selling local vegetables, fruit, flowers, plants and trees. By 10 a.m., the shops open, including The Antique House, Berkeley Springs Antique Mall, the Old Factory Mall, and Youngblood's Antiques. Do check the side streets for additional stores.

One doesn't need to be a connoisseur of antiques to come home with a "real find". Most shops will give you a discount, if you spend over a certain amount and pay with cash or a check . If an item has "character marks" (dents or cracks), it usually is dramatically reduced, yet often retains its charm and beauty. It never hurts to ask for a price break! Accept this as an invitation to enjoy the town of Bath!

ANNUAL MEETING DATE MAY CHANGE

The board will set the date for the annual meeting at the August meeting, but it is likely that it will not be on Labor Day weekend. Notices will be sent out in accordance with the By-laws and Covenants.

NEXT BOARD MEETING: Saturday, August 12, 10:00 a.m. at Coolfont.

Have an Item for the Newsletter?
Send it to:
Jackson Bain
609 Oakley Place
Alexandria, VA
22302

Cut out and place in your home, near the telephone:



POLICE, AMBULANCE OR FIRE

(304) 258-9911

War Memorial Hospital
Berkeley Springs

Emergency Room

Open 24 hours

Directions: From Coolfont, Left on Cold Run Valley Road.
Right on Route 9 into town.
Right on Washington Street, Left at the Courthouse onto Fairfax Street.
Go up hill to Hospital on the left, follow signs to Emergency Room.

(304) 258-1234